

Misogynoir at Work

When racism and sexism combine at the office

4 psychology approaches · tips & advice — by EvaTalk

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BEFORE YOU BEGIN

When racism and sexism combine at the office

Misogynoir — the specific discrimination Black women face, at the crossroads of racism and sexism — takes precise forms at work: being seen as ‘aggressive’ when you assert yourself, your expertise questioned, your ideas credited to others, repeated microaggressions. It isn't in your head.

This guide validates what you live, helps you protect your energy and self-esteem, and respond strategically — without carrying the burden alone.

Your intention

A misogynoir situation you live or have lived: _____

The 4 approaches

This guide works your topic through 4 complementary psychology lenses. Read, do the exercises, fill the workbook — at your own pace.

Psychodynamic — understand the root.

CBT — ease the negative thoughts.

Humanistic — reconcile with yourself.

Systemic — act on your environment.

The weight of internalizing

With repeated microaggressions and being doubted, you can end up doubting yourself, even blaming yourself. Understanding that the wound comes from outside — a biased system — and not from a flaw in you, is freeing.

On top of the discrimination, you don't have to carry the guilt of enduring it.

Example

From hearing she was 'too much', Aïcha had started to hold back. Understanding misogynoir helped her recognize her own innocence.

What I internalized

Write: which biased messages did I end up believing about myself?

What's me / what's misogynoir

Separate: what's truly about me / what's others' biased gaze.

→ *The wound comes from outside — not a flaw in me.*

Thoughts under misogynoir

'I must be twice as good and twice as gentle', 'if I assert myself, I'll be called aggressive'. These thoughts, born of a real reality, feed hypervigilance and exhaustion.

You can soften the fear without denying the reality of the discrimination.

Example

Sure she'd be judged 'aggressive', Nia self-censored. Telling real risk from her fear gave her voice back.

Thought journal

Note: the 'I must...' thought · what's real risk / what's amplified fear.

Reclaiming my voice

Pick ONE situation where asserting yourself is reasonable, and dare.

→ *I can tell real risk from fear — and keep my voice.*

Protecting your self-esteem

Don't let a biased gaze define your worth. Restoring a fair image of yourself — from your own truths, not others' judgment — is an act of resistance and self-care.

Your worth isn't negotiable based on others' gaze.

Example

Léa went back to leaning on her real achievements rather than biased remarks. Her self-esteem rose.

My truths about myself

List 5 truths about your worth (skills, qualities, achievements) that don't depend on others' gaze.

Self-compassion

A line to tell yourself after a microaggression: e.g. 'It's not me, it's their bias.'

→ *My worth isn't negotiable based on others' biased gaze.*

Responding strategically & building support

You don't have to absorb it all or carry it alone. Documenting, choosing your battles, calmly naming facts, leaning on allies, sponsors, HR and networks of Black women: these are strategies, not admissions of weakness.

Knowing when to respond, escalate, or leave is part of protecting yourself.

Example

When her idea was re-credited, Fatou calmly noted: 'that's the proposal I made earlier'. With an ally to credit her, it landed.

My strategy

For your situation: what I document · what I choose to address · whom I talk to.

My supports

List: 1 ally/sponsor · 1 network of Black women · 1 possible recourse (HR).

→ *Responding strategically and building support protects me.*

Practical tips & advice

Tips & advice

- Document (dates, facts, witnesses): useful for recourse, and unburdening.
- Name facts calmly: 'I proposed this idea 10 minutes ago'.
- Find allies who amplify and credit your ideas.
- Join a network of Black women: support, role models, advice.
- Choose your battles — you don't have to address everything or educate.
- Know your rights (HR, recourse) and protect your energy outside work.

To fill in

Facts journal

Date	The situation	How I felt	What I choose to do

My supports & rights

Ally / network / recourse	Next action

PLAN

Your 4-week plan

Week 1 — Free what I internalized.

Week 2 — Real risk or amplified fear?

Week 3 — Restore my self-esteem.

Week 4 — Respond strategically & build support.

Your plan in 3 lines

- The truth about myself I hold onto:
- What I choose to address:
- The support I enlist:

TO CLOSE

What you live is real. You're not the problem — and you're not alone.

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The misogyny you experience at work is real: this guide never questions it. It's a coaching and psychoeducation tool, not therapy or legal advice. If you're going through a hard time, you're not alone: reach out to a professional or a crisis line in your country. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.